

Vulnerability & Risk Assessment: Co-op 2025 Cyberattack

The vulnerability	description	Level	impact
Third-Party Supply Chain Risk	A key vulnerability was Co-op's reliance on external logistics and supply chain vendors with direct access to internal systems. The attackers did not initially target Co-op directly; instead, they compromised a trusted third-party vendor and leveraged that relationship to gain access.	Critical	- Expanded attack surface beyond Co-op's direct control. - Security became dependent on vendor security maturity. - Created a trusted pathway into internal networks.
Lack of Phishing-Resistant MFA	The compromised remote-access connection reportedly lacked phishing-resistant Multi-Factor Authentication.	Critical	- Stolen credentials alone were sufficient to gain access. - Increased exposure to credential theft and social engineering attacks. - Reduced resilience against identity-based attacks.

Centralised Repository of Customer Data	Co-op maintained a large centralised database containing information relating to approximately 6.5 million members.	High	• Created a high-value target for cybercriminals. • Increased the potential impact of data exfiltration. • Elevated reputational and regulatory risk.
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